

Personal, Social and Professional Communication (3)

Levels of Communication

Extrapersonal Communication means when human beings interact with non-human beings as we often talk to our pets, plants, trees.

Intrapersonal Communication - when we talk to ourselves; in pain, sufferings, anger, sadness, loneliness, etc. In this way we formulate our decisions and our brain talks to our body parts by sending them signals.

Interpersonal Communication - This type of Communication we share with other human beings. We are social human beings on personal, emotional, psychological, educational, social, cultural, professional, financial level need others help.

Organisational Communication - Communication that happens within an organisation is called Organisational Com - It is in three form -

- ① Internal talks with the inside fellows.
- ② External talks with the outside.
- ③ Personal - apart from professional talks.

Mass Communication - Communication through newspapers, magazines, journals, books, audio-visual mediums (Radio, T.V., internet), musical, theatrical performances, cinema are in this category. With the advent of new media - SMS, emails, advertisement also come in this category.

Types of Communication

Formal, informal, verbal, non-verbal, oral, written etc.

Verbal Communication

- By established rules of grammar to share emotions, feelings, informations. In two categories:

Verbal

Speech Oral Written

Non-verbal Communication

Signage - Sign Language - Patch of uniform black and white painted bands on the road means zebra crossing. Road sign, traffic signals, graphs, maps, alarms, sirens all convey their respective messages.

Audio signs - Drum beats, Conch blowing, The alarm clock, the office buzzer, doorbell, Car horn, telephone ring, are examples.

Visual signs - Basically graphics - The picture on a road sign, of a boy or girl running with a school bag suggests that there is a school ahead on the road, so slow down. A picture of a plate, a spoon and a fork suggest, there is a restaurant ahead.

Audio-visual - (C.T.V, Radio, films, cinema, multimedia)

Kinesics - means study of body movements, gestures, facial expressions and their connection with communication. examples - different dance mudras in dance, the silent films of Charlie Chaplin convey so much by the deft use of body language.

Subparts of kinesics - head and facial expression in dance, eye to eye contact in interviews or daily talks, gestures like showing full palm means stop, waving the hand means 'bye'. Postures - for example a person leaning his head backwards on the back of his chair means weariness. Rushing down the stairs suggests some urgency. Appearance - It is a combination of body, shape, movement, gesture, posture that a person presents voluntarily or involuntarily. Grooming, clothing and other sartorial accessories are very much a part of silhouette of a person. Fitness is necessary for any kind of work that makes the viewer and receiver confident that you can discharge your responsibilities.

Paralanguage - There are 'highlighters' of oral messages. Voice (means when we hear 'hello' over phone, we immediately get the idea of that person's gender, status, class, educational background comes to you.)

① Volume Variation - Volume variation makes oral communication lively if the receiver is far loud voice if near slow voice.

② Pitch variation - means shrillness of sound that allows oral message to be dynamic, removing the monotony of speech. Pitch variation indicates whether the person is emotionally charged or angry. Higher rank person will speak to subaltern in high pitch.

Clarity are - helps in dramatizing the utterance by creating ⁵ pauses in suspense.
Stress - In two kinds where words are stressed in a sentence or where different syllables of a word are stressed.

Inflections - (Small bits of sound) or you can say pronunciation or the way language is spoken. They reveal social, cultural, educational, regional, linguistic background of a person.

② Non-fluencies - They express the state of a person's mind, particularly in a moment of urgency. Like 'ohay', 'you know', 'oh', 'here'.

Proxemics: Space language → Surroundings → Example - office has cubicles for its staff in such a manner they are visible to each other. This would create an atmosphere of openness and allows greater interaction and transparency among colleagues. This kind of space organization also reflects corporate ethos or culture to denote hierarchy in the office.

Intimate, personal, social, and public spaces -
✓ In all these spaces you are told the importance of paralinguistics. But paralinguistics is in public or social spaces. In intimate or personal spaces body language is noticeable, as it is part of non-verbal communication. Paralinguistics is a part of oral communication.

③ Intimate space - Private zone where only family members or very close acquaintances are admissible. (Non-verbal communication like body language and touch are common because of physical proximity or closeness of the sender and the receiver who are visible to each other.)

Personal space - Even Body language continues to play a major role here since the receiver is still within audible and visible distance. Close associates and friends come in this category.

Social space - organizational communication takes place in it. Natural voice will work without technological aids like loudspeaker. Oral communication ^{and} paralinguistics are more powerful here. Requests, instructions, business talks, meetings, instructions come in this category.

Public space - It totally depends on paralinguistic skills. Body language has lesser ~~Public~~ role.

role here, oral communication and paralanguage have to

Chronemics: Time language & communication conveyed to a sense of time, is called chronemics. A person makes many suggestions about himself, his background and his organization comes in it. When train or flight delays, inconvenience is not only to travellers, image of railways or airlines also suffer. Chronemics is the ability to project time as a dimension of discipline, seriousness of purpose and punctuality. Time language is culture-specific, some people like Western European and US give great importance to time while others have a relaxed approach.

Haptics - Haptics or language of touch requires maximum sensitivity to culture. Patting on back, embrace, kissing, hand shaking are haptics gestures. What is acceptable practice in one culture may be unacceptable in another. Since it borrows heavily from customs one has to be wise in following it.

Listening - In oral communication listener or receiver is not equal powerful. Oral communication is successful only when signals of listening are strong.

Evaluative listening - when receiver already knows what is in second or third time just getting the clarification of the first things.

Discriminative listening - many sound signals are coming to receiver but he will receive those sounds, more important to him. [Means extract meaningful from chaotic or noisy situation]

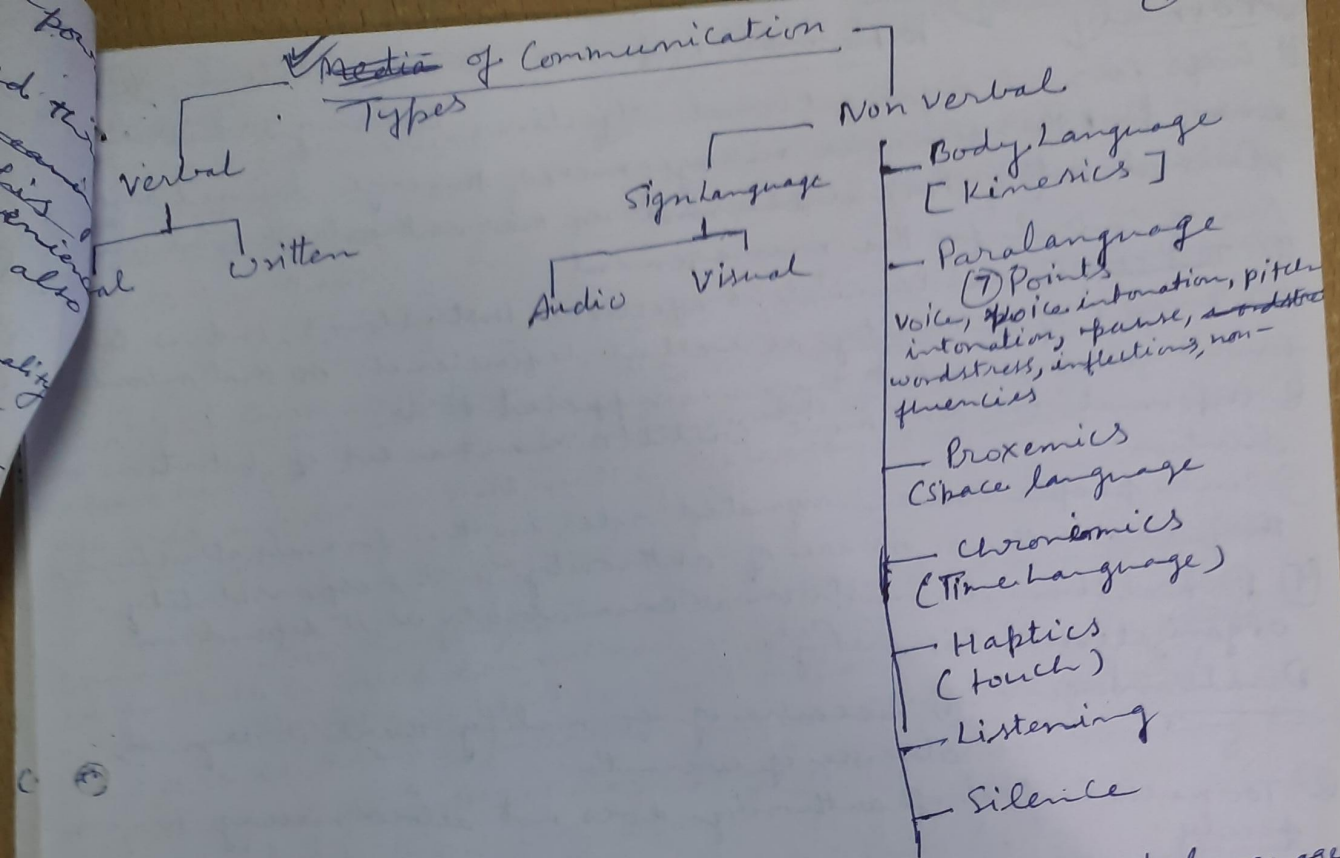
Appreciative listening - when listener needs to show interest so that sender remains motivated and messages.

Empathic listening - when the receiver puts himself in place of speaker and tries to understand the message from speaker's point of view.

Silence - A very passive nonverbal medium but very effective tool. It indicates mental status of a person. But it may send wrong signal that the person is not interested in talks or discussion.

On Page no 7 Chart is very important to know all points clearly

to substitute in the given para.



Verbal Communication - Grammatically structured language to convey ideas in a sophisticated manner.

Oral Communication - It is spontaneous, gets clarification or feedback quickly, paralanguage matters here, less formal, less economical too.

Drawbacks → Ephemeral, cannot be documented for future, limited period for formulation of ideas, waste of time, depends on sharp memory or retention power, no legal validity, responsibility cannot be fixed.

Written Communication - Banal, clarification or feedback not possible quickly, proxemics, chronemics matters here, quite formal, expensive (clutter of excess paper).

Qualities → It is permanent, can be documented for future, ample of time for formulation of ideas, utilization of time, greater credibility and accuracy, full legal validity, authoritative.

of the ~~existing~~ channel

Formal Formal, Informal communication

It helps to meet organizational objectives. Contrary to hierarchy, ^{people} ~~message~~ ^{move} through defined or coterie heartbeats outside the

planned paths. Formal channel is the authorized communication line of control for the management.

① This ~~the~~ Formal channel is effective. Instructions, orders carry the weight of authority as well as definiteness so that subordinates know for sure what they are supposed to do.

② Informations are more. Credible no chances of distortion or dilution.

③ Since people have designated roles in the formal structure, they know their sphere of authority and responsibility.

④ Formal channel insists on accountability as it depends on organizational hierarchy.

Disadvantages - ① Because of formality there is dryness, absence of warmth.

- ② Too much control of authority does not allow message to move freely.
- ③ It is time consuming as in the case with written communication.
- ④ Too expensive in financial terms. Maintenance and documentation of written records make the formal channel expensive.

Informal channel

- ① Non-hierarchical, popularly known as grapevine channel. It is driven more by personal need to communicate rather than positional.
- ② This has direct relationship ^{among} ~~to~~ people's bond with each other. ^{They know how to} ~~at the workplace~~, irrespective of positions, independently.
- ③ It is oral, undocumented, conveys information based on hearsay ^{and} personal impressions.
- ④ It fulfils very basic human needs to share thoughts and ideas.

Drawbacks or disadvantages

- ① It was felt by the upper levels in organizations that this channel has full possibility to harm by spreading rumours and inauthentic informations.
- ② When organization is facing tough time, speculating. Domsday, ^{the} ~~the~~ job uncertainty or insecurity comes to people or they start speaking non-sense.
- ③ When new technologies are introduced, the people feel incapable to handle them or triggers to misgivings about

If or Functional Structure - Specialists and functional

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r.

This shows lack of self-confidence or feelings of inadequacy.

Coterie (favoured group) by the manager develops, it may create heartburn among others, and others may be left out. The people outside the 'chosen few' develop a feeling of animosity towards the other.

Directions of Communication (Flow of Communication)

Vertical Communication - It consists of both upward and downward communication. When communication travels from the upper levels to lower levels or vice versa, it moves vertically upwards and downwards in the hierarchy, it is called vertical communication.

Downward

Communication that originates at an upper level and is sent to lower level is called downstream or downward. It is also called authoritative as it conveys to the subordinate staff what is to be done. Important functions of Downward:

- ① managers ^{are} psychologically satisfied in executing their managerial functions with a sense of authority.
- ② Coordination ^{within in or other} ~~as~~ different departments.
- ③ ~~Encouragement~~ Encouragement and motivation to achieve organizational goals.
- ④ By instructions from superiors, subordinates know clearly what they have to do.

Limitations

① Distortion and Dilution - message has to travel across too many levels so this problem may be ^{mediator} reduced by the number of intermediaries between origin and destination of the message, alternatives like notices, newsletters, open door policy should be used adopted.

② Filtering - When middlemen like manager keeps some info ^{info} ~~with him~~ and allows the rest to pass, thinking all info are not palatable to others. But this habit means filtering could lead to misinformation.

③ Message abbreviation - If you are shortening the original message, it may take away important portions.

④ Delay - ~~Downward~~ ^{Downward} Communication often travels through formal channel with designated paths or procedure. This causes delay. For urgent messages, oral medium or informal channels are good. Since downward ~~co~~-moves from individuals with greater authority, it often tends to disregard or ignore the feedback, making communication process one-way. This may cause errors of judgement.

overuse of one way process may make organization more authoritative or less participatory.

Psychological Factors - ego, resistance, Ego in manager is above team and resistance among workers will come in the way of team. ^{responsible may not cooperate}
job motivation and fulfilling organizational objectives.
should use this method with sensitivity and care with persuasive approach rather than authoritative.
(why resistance - because too much orders or instructions, ind
from seniors but ^{no} way to ^{seniors} juniors self-esteem)

Upward

Information that originates at lower levels of the hierarchy and travels to higher level is called upward communication. Since these are more people at the base of the ^{pyramidal} structure and lesser ~~more~~ number as one climbs the ladder. Moreover the subordinates may be unsure as to how their message would be received. The primary use of upward communication is feedback. This communication is one to one meetings with one's superiors, ^{presenting} reports, suggestions, grievances, employee attitude, surveys, etc come in this category.

~~Managers must dispel hesitation and fear so that they receive adequate feedback.~~

Limitations

The initiative for upward communication is in the hands of superiors. They should be sensitive to feedback channel, or in keeping warm relationship with ^{their} juniors.

Distortion and Dilution - Favourable information will go upward while unfavourable will be held back, in an attempt not to displease the superiors, the message could be distorted or diluted.

Filtering - Subordinates hesitate in conveying the entire message and thus important points ^{or portions} are filtered out.

Information overload - If every message is moved upwards without being tackled at their appropriate level, the top level will have too many messages to handle. Since the apex of the organization has fewer people, they will be victim of information overload.

Psychological Factors - Issue of authority and communicating criticism - This makes subordinates reserve ^{because of code of respect for the higher people juniors are silent.} for criticism. Authority thinks openness might create disrespect for them.

...ing of Superior level - Sometimes, subordinates may bypass ⁽¹¹⁾ their immediate superiors to reach out to ⁽¹³⁾ those above theirs. Immediate superior expresses his displeasure not cooperating or taking responsibility ^{from} his subordinate's expert work.

Lateral or Horizontal

When individuals located at the same level in the organization interact. meeting, reports, memo, telephonic or face-to-face conversation where information is exchanged between people at the same level are examples of this communication. Because of this equality of rank, hierarchy does not create psychological or ego barrier and therefore smooth functioning possible.

Qualities - Coordination in job, problem solving, decision-making, Sharing of ideas and information, proving peer support and resolving conflicts.

Limitations

- ① Absence of authoritative messages.
- ② Rivalry among individuals - if one message is suppressing others views or giving disadvantage to others, aggressive rivalry will develop among them.
- ③ Professional Conflict - People get into a psychological mind-trap of arrogance and jealousy which starts to affect their communication. Since conflicting parties are at par in rank, restraint within them becomes difficult to insist upon.
- ④ Lack of Appreciation of work of other units - Because of interdepartmental rivalry this would happen.
- ⑤ Decrease of motivation - All are of the same rank who will not motivate to whom.

Diagonal

When individuals from different levels interact with each other. For example, when the production manager interacts with the assistant sales manager. This method allows information exchange between different levels directly and could provide solutions to different problems.

Qualities
① Informal interaction - takes place without interfering in others departments.
② Elimination of delay, coordination in functioning, Control of distortion or dilution by direct, inter-level communication.

Limitations

Interference - Sometimes, people take liberty or start interfering in others work.

Bypassing Vertical Chain of Command - In its effort to shorten talking route, this system actually breeds

suspicious and misgivings.

Jeopardizes superior's Cooperation and Accountability - The ~~past~~ ^{case at physical, material level}

bypassed superior may not cooperate with the work agreed upon by the other superior and his subordinate, or he may simply refuse to take part for anything in which he is not privy.

Psychological Resistance - The bypassed superior may develop a psychological resistance towards implementing decisions as he was not allowed to participate in the consultation.

Tendency Towards Anarchy - It may lead to superiors getting too involved in matters of other departments than their own.

Organizational Structure Communication Networks

OR Different Channels of Communication Organizational Structures

Line Structure - This is modelled on the concept that at each level of the organization, ^{say} people supervise, control and administer the work of a group of the next lower level. Messages, instructions are sent below and information, reports, requests are sent upwards.

Advantages - ① Administrative accountability of people at each level.

② A person knows well what he has to do, to whom he/she has to control, or obey.

Disadvantages - ① Long length of communication ^{may} ~~cause~~ ^{create} unnecessary delay or confusion.

② Being basically a line of authority, the top levels are ^{is} overloaded with information.

How to sort out difficulties - The line of communication ~~can be~~ ^{and} reduced by flattening

the pyramid a bit, for example by a senior manager, by using general notices, newsletters or by addressing several levels together.

Off or Functional Structure - Specialists and functional managers will come in this category.

it is not purely functional, as there is need for overall coordination.

Advantages - ① Availability of specialist knowledge and expert advice. ② Line of Communication shorter.

disadvantage - ① Priorities of workers difficult to ascertain. ② Conflicting instructions from many supervisors create confusion among workers.

Solution - Clear distinction of job roles and definition of responsibilities will solve problems.

Committee Structure - A group of people decided by organization to conduct C.O or meetings. This structure allows discussion-oriented and democratic environment.

disadvantage is, this process is time consuming demands so much meetings.

Matrix Structure - This structure is a variation of the staff structure. There is an overall manager to whom the following report:

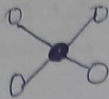
- ① Executive project managers - each responsible for the execution of a specific project.
- ② Specialist functional managers - for specialist activity.

Advantage - ① Short line of communication ② Interdisciplinary approach

disadvantage - It is not permanent arrangement as if one of the managers lose control of the staff, great fiasco. only for finite projects like research, development and design will work.

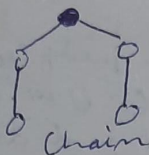
Communication is not simply a matter of exchanges between the sender or the receiver, it has important social dimension especially in organization. These dimensions are particular systems or networks. The larger the size of organization, the greater is the need for well-structured communication networks. People simply ignore certain messages if patterns of transmission not suitable. The most prominent among them are the wheel, the chain, the circle and the all-channel network.

In the wheel or the Star network the members communicate with the central member separately. The central member is a superior authority and the surrounding ones his subordinates. The wheel network represents centralization of authority and a great deal of central and coordination of informations.



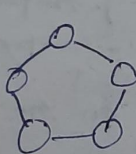
wheel

The Chain network presents a situation where two members at the far ends of the chain have to communicate with the central person through their respective intermediaries. This network is centralized, however the intermediaries share with the centre the control and authority of the channel.



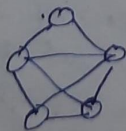
Chain

The Circle network has its members situated in a position where an individual may communicate with ~~the~~ ^{the} others next to him. There is no central figure. This ^{egalitarian approach} matches with horizontal communication where people at the same level interact with one-another.



circle

All-Channel network allows maximum freedom where anybody may communicate to anyone. ^{There is} Not only decentralized but also a route for fast information exchange. This channel is a major contributor towards grapevine channels and could be misused to spread rumours.



All channel Network